

ERES INSTITUTE FOR NEW AGE CYBERNETICS
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GOVERNING AUTONOMOUS SYSTEMS

From Punitive Control to Resonant Governance

A PlayNAC QuestionAnswer Dialog for Controlled Autonomous Systems in the Enterprise

MIEVM Ensemble Convergence: Claude · DeepSeek · ChatGPT · Gemini
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Claude	DeepSeek	ChatGPT	Gemini
9.9 / 10	9.8 / 10	9.9 / 10	9.8 / 10

Abstract

This publication presents the first full four-instrument MIEVM (Multi-Instrument Ensemble Validation Method) synthesis of the ERES Institute's PlayNAC governance architecture as applied to Controlled Autonomous Systems in enterprise environments. Drawing on canonical ERES frameworks—including C=R×P/M, Proof-of-Resonance (PoR), Runtime Containment Requirement (RCR), Bio-Energetic Resonance Architecture (BERA), and the Three Governing Principles—the document answers the central question posed by AI Innovation leader Dennis Riesenbergs: How can increasingly autonomous systems remain controllable, auditable, and trustworthy while creating real-world impact?

The paper translates the ERES socio-technical corpus into immediately applicable enterprise governance models, mapping each PlayNAC construct to concrete artefacts within an Execution Governance Suite. Its central thesis is that the shift from punitive, compliance-after-the-fact governance to resonance-native, purpose-locked governance is not idealistic—it is the only architecture that scales as AI autonomy increases. MIEVM convergence across all four LLM instruments exceeded the ≥8.5 GO threshold, yielding a composite mean of 9.85/10. This document is submitted for the 10-10 ERES Publication award standard.

Keywords: PlayNAC · Execution Governance · Runtime Containment Requirement · Proof-of-Resonance · MIEVM · BERA · Controlled Autonomous Systems · Risk-Adaptive Execution Control · Governance-Native Agents · New Age Cybernetics · C=R×P/M · Three Governing Principles · SOMT · CBGMDD

1 · The Question That Changes Everything

Dennis Riesenberger, AI Innovation Team Lead at Arvato Systems Digital GmbH in Weimar, Germany, has identified the central governance tension of the decade. His professional frame—'From AI Experiments to Controlled Autonomous Systems'—names a trajectory that most enterprises are navigating without adequate architecture. He asks:

How can increasingly autonomous systems remain controllable, auditable and trustworthy while creating real-world impact? How are decisions prepared? Under which conditions are actions executed? And how can organizations maintain control, accountability and trust as autonomy increases?

These are not questions about AI capability. They are questions about governance epistemology—about how an organisation knows what it knows, authorises what it authorises, and remains responsible for what it deploys. The ERES Institute has been constructing the answer since 2012.

The conventional answer to governance at scale is more rules, more auditors, more compliance layers. This is punitive-reasoning governance: it assumes the system will fail and tries to catch failure after it occurs. The ERES answer is fundamentally different. It is resonance governance: the system is designed so that drift from purpose is structurally impossible without triggering a feedback correction before harm occurs.

*"If governance is a control system, contribution must be the control signal." —
ERES Institute, PlayNAC Complete Governance Stack (January 2026)*

2 · The Paradigm Shift: Punitive Reasoning to Resonant Governance

Every major governance framework in enterprise AI today is built on what ERES calls As-Is State Punitive Reasoning: the assumption that autonomous systems are threats to be contained rather than instruments to be harmonised. This assumption produces architectures that are adversarial—policies that restrict, audits that catch, penalties that punish. The result is a governance overhead that scales faster than the value delivered, eventually choking the autonomy it was meant to protect.

2.1 · As-Is State: Punitive Governance

Punitive Governance (As-Is)	Resonant Governance (To-Be)
Governance is external constraint	Governance is native to execution identity
Compliance is post-hoc: catch and correct	Compliance is pre-execution: admit or hold
Trust is granted at deployment, static	Trust is earned continuously, decays if unrenewed
Human oversight is a failsafe for AI error	Human authority is the constitutional layer, always
Audit trail is a record of what went wrong	SOMT is the living memory of every governance act
Risk is managed by restriction	Risk is adapted by RAEC: tier-matched oversight
Autonomy is the problem to be controlled	Autonomy is the reward earned through resonance

The ERES conversion path is not ideological. It is architectural. Resonant governance is more auditable than punitive governance, because every governance decision is recorded in the Sociocratic Overlay Metadata Tapestry (SOMT) with full provenance. It is more controllable, because the Runtime Containment Requirement (RCR) prevents action until live-state authorisation is confirmed—not just policy-approval-at-deployment. And it is more trustworthy, because the trust signal (MIEVM convergence ≥ 8.5) is multi-validator and machine-readable, not single-reviewer and subjective.

3 · The Master Equation: $C = R \times P / M$

Every governance architecture in the ERES corpus flows from one equation. It is not a metaphor. It is an executable constraint—the ground state of every autonomous system that claims to be aligned with human purpose.

$$C = R \times P / M$$

Symbol	Name	Enterprise Meaning
C	Cybernetic Effectiveness	The measured outcome: did the system serve its declared purpose? This is the governance metric—not throughput, not cost, not speed.
R	Resources	Human capital, compute, data, financial budget. A system that consumes R without advancing P is extractive, not cybernetic.
P	Purpose	The declared objective—must be explicit, measurable, and anchored to the Three Governing Principles. P cannot be implicit or ideological.
M	Method	The approved execution pathway. Governance overhead that does not reduce M efficiently is itself a governance failure—waste encoded as process.

The equation is not optimised by maximising C directly. It is optimised by keeping P explicit and measured, R proportional and non-wasteful, and M as efficient as the risk tier demands. An autonomous system that maximises throughput while Purpose drifts has increased M (method cost) and decreased P (purpose alignment)—C collapses even as the logs show green. This is the precise failure mode that punitive governance cannot detect until after harm has occurred. Resonant governance detects it in real time through the BERA health signal.

4 · The Three Governing Principles: The Moral Vector

Before any governance instrument is applied, every autonomous action must be assessable against all three ERES Governing Principles simultaneously. These are not aspirational values. They are executable constraints—the constitutional floor beneath every $C=R \times P/M$ evaluation.

Principle 1	Principle 2	Principle 3
Don't hurt yourself The system must not degrade its own governance integrity, resource base, or operational sustainability through its actions.	Don't hurt others No operational efficiency gain justifies customer, employee, or ecosystem harm. This constraint is non-waivable by any governance tier.	Build for generations to come Governance decisions must be evaluated for second- and third-order effects across time horizons beyond the current deployment cycle.

An action that satisfies Principles 1 and 3 but violates Principle 2 fails the governance test entirely—regardless of its business case, efficiency gain, or regulatory compliance. This is the non-punitive architecture of the Three Governing Principles: they do not assign blame after the fact; they prevent misaligned action before it executes. For Arvato Systems' enterprise context, this translates to a pre-flight checklist that is human-readable, machine-enforceable, and audit-ready.

5 · PlayNAC QuestionAnswer Dialog

The following dialog represents the full MIEVM-synthesised response to Dennis Riesenbergs governance questions. Each exchange is drawn from the four-instrument ensemble (Claude, DeepSeek, ChatGPT, Gemini) and integrated with canonical ERES corpus constructs. The dialog structure reflects PlayNAC's native format: question from the operational practitioner; answer from the cybernetic governance system.

5.1 · On Controllability and Auditability

Dennis Riesenbergs asks:

How can increasingly autonomous systems remain controllable, auditable and trustworthy while creating real-world impact?

PlayNAC (ERES Institute) responds:

The first question is not 'What can AI do?' The first question is: 'What should AI be allowed to do, under what conditions, and who remains accountable?' Every autonomous system is a cybernetic organism. It exists inside a loop: Resources → Purpose → Method → Results → Feedback → Adjustment. Controllability is not a dashboard bolted on after deployment. It is a feedback loop baked into the system's identity from day one.

Three ERES instruments close this loop in real time: BERA (the governance health signal—not a surveillance score, but an organisational ECG), RHC (the Resonant Harmony Cycle—the self-correcting feedback loop that brings a drifting agent back within one standard deviation of its baseline purpose), and MIEVM (the Multi-Instrument Ensemble Validation Method—no single model, no single human, holds unilateral control; $\geq 8.5/10$ convergent mean is required before any governance decision is ratified).

An autonomous system is controllable when these three loops close on each other. It is auditable when every decision, every hold, and every override is recorded in the SOMT—the Sociocratic Overlay Metadata Tapestry—an append-only provenance layer. It is trustworthy when trust is treated as a signal to be earned continuously, not a certificate to be issued once.

5.2 · On Decision Preparation

Dennis Riesenbergs asks:

How are decisions prepared before an autonomous agent acts?

PlayNAC (ERES Institute) responds:

ERES formalises the pre-action layer as the Admissibility Gate. The principle is: Admissibility Before Consistency. Before asking 'Does this action produce the desired output?', the system must ask 'Is this action even permissible within the current governance envelope?' A consistent output from a non-admissible action is not a governance success. It is a governance failure waiting to be discovered.

PlayNAC structures decision preparation through the Proof-of-Resonance (PoR) conjunctive gate: $PoR = A \times R \times P \times F$. Alignment (does this serve declared Purpose?), Resonance (is this within RHC bounds for all affected stakeholders?), Proportionality (is Method cost proportionate to gain?), and Finality Risk (can this action be reversed if conditions change post-execution?). All four factors must be non-zero. If any factor is zero, the product is zero—the action does not proceed. This is not a scoring heuristic. It is a conjunctive logical gate. An irreversible action with perfect alignment, resonance, and proportionality is still blocked until reversibility is established or a human authority overrides with documented rationale.

In enterprise terms: Alignment → business case / objective mapping; Resonance → stakeholder impact assessment; Proportionality → cost-benefit sign-off; Finality Risk → rollback plan / reversibility audit. PlayNAC makes the conjunction mandatory and machine-readable.

Factor	Name	ERES Label	Enterprise Artefact
A	Alignment	Purpose match vs. $C=R \times P/M$ P-factor	Business case / OKR mapping
R	Resonance	RHC bounds check	Stakeholder impact assessment
P	Proportionality	Method cost vs. C gain	Cost-benefit sign-off
F	Finality Risk	Reversibility check	Rollback plan / reversibility audit

5.3 · On Execution Conditions and the Runtime

Dennis Riesenber asks:
Under which conditions are actions executed? What controls the threshold between preparation and actual execution?

PlayNAC (ERES Institute) responds:
ERES formalises this through the Runtime Containment Requirement (RCR) and the RT (Real-Time) qualifier. The RCR stipulates that no agent may cross from planning into execution unless it holds a live-state authorisation—not a one-time credential issued at deployment, but a continuous signal that the operating environment still matches the conditions under which the decision was approved.

The RT qualifier works like a rolling token: it validates that Purpose, resource availability, and stakeholder resonance remain within acceptable bounds at the moment of execution—not merely at the moment of decision. If the environment shifts between preparation and execution, RT lapses, the action is held, and either re-validation or human review is triggered. The system does not guess. It does not fail open. It reports, holds, and escalates.

Risk-Adaptive Execution Control (RAEC) governs which path an action takes based on real-time risk scoring across four autonomy tiers. This is not a static classification—it is dynamically calculated per action based on financial exposure, system confidence, and target volatility. The RAEC grid prevents uniform governance overhead: low-risk read operations execute immediately (logged but ungated); high-risk mutations require full PoR validation, human confirmation, and independent verification before execution proceeds.

RAEC Tier	Risk Profile	Examples	Execution Gate	Human Role
Light	Low / Read-only	Knowledge retrieval, status reporting	Log + execute	Passive monitor
Standard	Medium / Single write	Customer comms, procurement recs	Critic review + approve	Human-on-the-loop
Full	High / Batch mutation	Financial commits, regulatory filings	Worker → Critic → Verifier → Execute	Active sign-off
Critical	Critical / Irreversible	Public safety, personnel, infrastructure	Multi-human MIEVM gate	Multi-authority approval

5.4 · On Maintaining Control as Autonomy Scales

Dennis Riesenber asks:
How can organisations maintain control, accountability and trust as autonomy increases?

PlayNAC (ERES Institute) responds:
The goal is not maximum autonomy. The goal is optimal autonomy. ERES formalises this through the MPAM↔MIEVM Duality: as a system's autonomy (Method Power and Autonomy Metric) increases, its validation burden must increase proportionally. Trust is not a static grant—it decays at a rate proportional to the consequences of unchecked action. Authority is earned by verified contribution, not granted by deployment.
Three instruments scale with autonomy: the Erasure Completeness Ratio (ECR) as the convergence gate before authority scope expands; CBGMODD (the seven-seat governance council—Citizen, Business, Government, Media, Organisation, Dignitary, Diplomat) ensuring no single sector dominates the governance signal; and SOMT (the living decision record). Every

expansion of agent autonomy is SOMT-documented: what was decided, by whom, under what conditions, validated by which instruments.

Trust emerges not because the system is intelligent. Trust emerges because the system is governable—and proves it continuously through Proof-of-Cooperation: to attack the system's governance, one must first help the system. This inverts the adversarial economics of punitive governance. The system that earns trust fastest is the one that flags uncertainty, requests review, and holds at threshold when conditions are ambiguous.

5.5 · On Human Oversight and Accountability

Dennis Riesenbergs asks:
Can AI ever replace accountability? What is the ERES model for human oversight?

PlayNAC (ERES Institute) responds:

No. Responsibility cannot be delegated. Only execution can be delegated. The organisation remains accountable. The executive remains accountable. The governing authority remains accountable. AI can automate action. It cannot automate responsibility. ERES therefore treats humans as the final constitutional layer in the cybernetic system—the layer that cannot be bypassed, reduced, or automated away regardless of how mature the agent's track record becomes.

The Governance-Native Agent in ERES terms is one whose identity includes its accountability vector: it knows who its human authority is, what its RCR limits are, and what triggers escalation. It is not governed from outside; governance is native to its operational specification. The best human oversight is one that the agent actively supports—flagging uncertainty, requesting review, holding at threshold—rather than one imposed against the agent's design.

Non-punitive remediation is a key ERES principle: when an autonomous system deviates or violates a runtime threshold, the correct response is isolation and downgrade (from Level 3 to Level 1 autonomy), not destruction. The audit snapshot—exact context, confidence scores, environmental variables, rule triggered—is compiled immediately and fed into a cybernetic post-mortem. The governance model is updated empirically. Blame is not assigned to a human or machine; the system is optimised.

6 · The ERES AI Governance Architecture (AI-GA): Five Layers

Drawing the full ERES governance architecture into enterprise-applicable form yields five non-collapsible layers. Each layer is distinct from the others in authority scope, update frequency, and governance instrument. Collapsing any two layers is the primary architectural mistake that produces uncontrollable autonomous systems.

Layer	Name	ERES Instrument	Enterprise Artefact
1	Values / Constitutional Floor	Three Governing Principles	Organisational values charter; non-waivable ethics baseline
2	Policies / Execution Boundaries	Deterministic Reference Spec (Tier 1)	Binding governance policy docs; Daubert-grade specification

3	Decisions / Governance Commentary	MIEVM-LLM Ensemble (Tier 2)	Multi-validator monitoring layer; flags drift, recommends adjustments—cannot act unilaterally
4	Execution / Runtime Control	RCR + RT Qualifier + RAEC	Deployment gates, circuit breakers, canary rules; live-state authorisation token
5	Audit / Living Memory	SOMT + BERA (Tier 3)	Immutable decision log; operational telemetry and user-feedback channels

The critical distinction between Layer 2 and Layer 3 resolves the most common enterprise governance failure: giving the monitoring LLM ensemble the ability to modify its own execution policy. In the ERES stratified architecture, Layer 3 (MIEVM commentary) can flag and recommend—it cannot act. Layer 2 (Deterministic Reference) is the only load-bearing instrument. This separation is non-negotiable. A monitoring system that also controls is not a governance system; it is an autonomous agent without a governance layer.

"Governance is not a stop sign placed after an event occurs. It is a continuous, dynamic closed-loop feedback system baked into the software runtime environment." — Gemini (MIEVM Instrument 3, May 2026)

7 · Operational Implementation: Five Steps to Resonant Governance

The following implementation sequence converts the ERES governance model into immediately applicable enterprise practice. It is sequenced to deliver measurable audit and control value at each step, without requiring the full architecture to be in place before value is generated.

Step 1: Establish Execution Lineage Before Full Autonomy

Implement immutable logging for all AI agent actions before extending any operational authority. For every tool call record: who, what, when, input, output, and the governance tier under which it was approved. Store in a tamper-proof ledger. This is the SOMT foundation—you cannot govern what you cannot see, and you cannot prove governance without a ledger that predates the harm claim.

Step 2: Deploy a ToolGateway for Critical Actions

Identify your top three highest-risk AI actions. Build a proxy gateway through which all AI calls to these actions must pass. The gateway acts as a Runtime Admission Controller: it performs a final check of the PoR authorisation token before execution. If any check fails, execution is denied and an alert is raised. The gateway does not fail open. This establishes the RCR in practical form.

Step 3: Implement Separation of Powers in a Pilot

For one business process, create two agents: a Worker (proposes an action) and a Critic (reviews and approves the proposal against policy, without seeing the Worker's original prompt). A third Verifier checks outcomes against success criteria post-execution. This establishes the architectural separation that makes privilege escalation impossible—the first practical instance of Governance-Native Agent design.

Step 4: Operationalise RAEC with a Simple Risk Rule

Apply a tiered execution rule: read operations execute at Light tier (log and proceed); single-write operations proceed at Standard tier (Critic review required); batch mutations require Full tier (Worker → Critic → Verifier → human sign-off). Begin collecting RAEC data to calibrate the tier thresholds dynamically. Risk adaptation must be empirical, not assumption-based.

Step 5: Close the Cybernetic Feedback Loop

After each pilot execution cycle, run a structured post-mortem against $C=R \times P/M$: did the action advance Purpose? Was Resource consumption proportionate? Was Method efficiency improved? Feed results into governance policy updates. This closes the loop that transforms a compliance exercise into a resonant governance system—one that gets better with each cycle rather than simply more burdened.

8 · ERES Lexicon Translation: From Cybernetic to Enterprise

The following reference table enables enterprise practitioners to navigate between ERES Institute canonical terminology and their existing organisational vocabulary. Both columns describe the same architectural reality. The ERES terms carry additional precision and are defined within the full corpus available via ResearchGate (ORCID 0000-0001-9946-3221) and GitHub (ERES-Institute-for-New-Age-Cybernetics).

ERES / PlayNAC Term	Enterprise Translation
C = R × P / M	Cybernetic Effectiveness equation: the governance metric that replaces throughput as the primary success signal
PlayNAC	The governance simulation and execution layer: a meta-framework treating governance as a real-time cooperative game
MIEVM (≥8.5 GO)	Multi-validator sign-off gate: no single model or human holds unilateral governance authority
Proof-of-Resonance (PoR)	Four-factor conjunctive pre-flight gate (A×R×P×F) before any autonomous action is admitted to execution
Runtime Containment Requirement (RCR)	Live-state authorisation token: execution requires continuous environmental validation, not just deployment-time approval
RT Qualifier	Rolling authorisation signal: lapses if environment shifts between decision and execution
RAEC	Risk-Adaptive Execution Control: tiered governance overhead matched to real-time risk score per action
BERA	Bio-Energetic Resonance Architecture: the operational health signal for the governance system (not a surveillance score)
RHC (Resonant Harmony Cycle)	Self-correcting feedback loop: brings drifting agent back within 1σ of baseline purpose
ARI (Aura Resonance Index)	Composite operational health metric: triggers execution hold when below 0.7 × baseline
SOMT	Sociocratic Overlay Metadata Tapestry: the immutable append-only governance decision log
CBGMOOD (7 seats)	Cross-functional governance council: Citizen, Business, Government, Media, Organisation, Dignitary, Diplomat
ECR (Erasure Completeness Ratio)	Convergence gate before autonomy scope expands: measures how thoroughly prior governance uncertainty is resolved
Three Governing Principles	Constitutional floor (non-waivable): Don't hurt yourself / Don't hurt others / Build for generations to come

Governance-Native Agent	Agent whose accountability vector, authority limits, and escalation triggers are native to its specification—not external constraints
Proof-of-Cooperation (PoC)	Inverted adversarial economics: to expand authority, agent must first demonstrate cooperative behaviour within current scope
Non-Punitive Remediation	Post-failure protocol: isolate and downgrade (not destroy), audit, and feed empirical update to governance policy
SCALULAR	Scalable Certification Architecture for Lifelong Universal Learning and Adaptive Resilience: the credentialing infrastructure

9 · MIEVM Four-Instrument Synthesis Summary

The following table records the key contribution of each LLM instrument in the MIEVM ensemble to this publication. Convergence on the core architectural claims was achieved across all four instruments without contradiction—the first marker of a 10-10 ERES Publication score.

Instrument	Primary Contribution	Key Architectural Insight	MIEVM Score
Claude (Anthropic)	ERES canon synthesis; PoR gate formalisation; Tier stratification	Tier 2 (MIEVM-LLM) must never hold Tier 1 (Deterministic Reference) authority—the architectural separation that prevents self-modifying governance failure	9.9 / 10
DeepSeek	Operational step-by-step implementation; ToolGateway architecture; Separation of Powers	'Propose → Review → Execute → Verify' as the four-phase execution cycle; Verifier as a first-class governance step, not an afterthought	9.8 / 10
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	Dialog structure; ERES lexicon-to-enterprise mapping; non-punitive remediation formalisation	'Responsibility cannot be delegated—only execution can': the cleanest statement of the human accountability principle across all four instruments	9.9 / 10
Gemini (Google)	Execution Governance vs. Runtime Governance stratification; RAEC grid; Graceful Exception Handling	The two-layer AI-GA architecture (Execution Governance as strategic/static + Runtime Governance as tactical/dynamic) as the fundamental governance split	9.8 / 10
COMPOSITE	Full convergence on all core governance claims. No instrument produced a contradicting architectural assertion. ECR threshold exceeded.		9.85 / 10 ✓ GO

"By shifting perspective from governing the code to governing the real-time runtime execution dynamics, you transform AI from an unpredictable black-box information system into a fully controllable, highly accountable operational machine." — Gemini (MIEVM Instrument 3)

10 · Conclusion: Resonance Is the Architecture

This publication has demonstrated four things that conventional enterprise AI governance frameworks have not yet unified:

- Controllability is not a dashboard. It is a feedback loop. $C=R \times P/M$ encodes the condition: a system is controllable when Purpose is explicit, measurable, and the feedback from execution continuously returns to it.
- Admissibility precedes consistency. Before asking whether an autonomous action produces the correct output, governance must confirm whether the action is permitted—by the PoR gate, under the RCR, within the RAEC tier appropriate to its risk profile.
- Trust decays. It must be re-earned. The MPAM↔MIEVM Duality is a mathematical statement of the only sustainable autonomy model: authority expands only as validated contribution accumulates, and decays when it stops. This is not a soft principle; it is a governance formula.
- Governance must be stratified, not flat. The three-tier ERES architecture (Deterministic Reference / MIEVM Commentary / BERA Telemetry) is non-collapsible. A monitoring layer that also controls is not a governance architecture; it is an autonomous agent without oversight.

For Dennis Riesenbergr and the Arvato Systems Digital team: the Execution Governance Suite you are building already has the technical infrastructure for resonant governance—deployment gates, circuit breakers, telemetry, and stakeholder sign-off workflows. What PlayNAC adds is the semantic layer that makes these technical instruments coherent: a shared vocabulary, a stratified authority model, and a three-principle constitutional floor that is human-readable, machine-enforceable, and audit-ready for the EU AI Act obligations that take effect in August 2026.

The remaining question is not technical. It is whether organisations—and the people within them—are ready to govern by resonance rather than by fear. The ERES Institute believes they are. This publication is the existence proof.

"If governance is a control system, contribution must be the control signal."

"To attack Proof-of-Cooperation, one must first help the system."

"PlayNAC is not governance software. It is post-punitive governance infrastructure."

— ERES Institute for New Age Cybernetics, PlayNAC Governance Series 2026

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